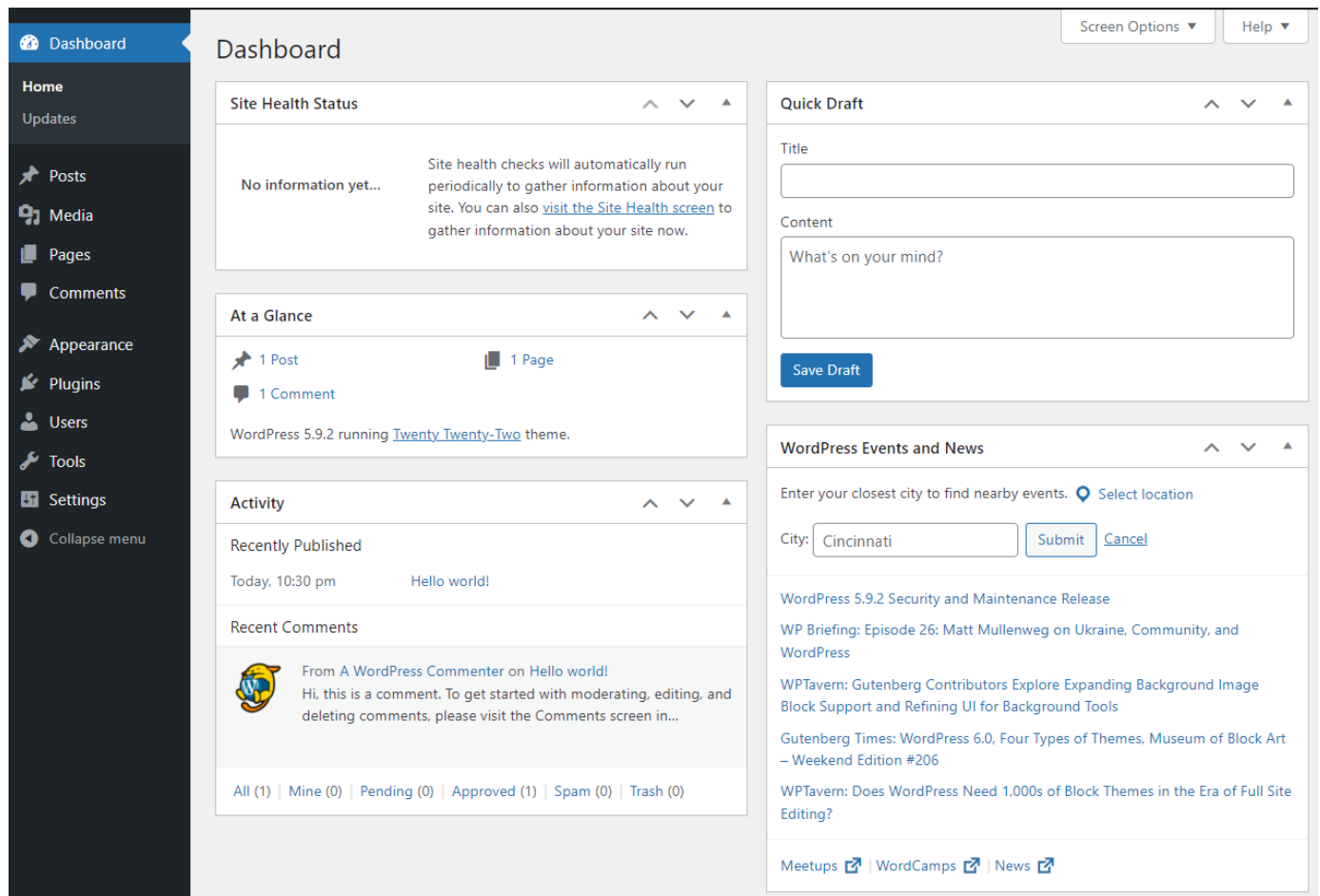


What is the WordPress admin dashboard?

The WordPress dashboard is the CMS control panel. Every WordPress installation has an admin panel with the same features and tools. Think about the dashboard as the “back end” of your site, where you configure and manage everything related to it.

Here’s what a regular WordPress admin dashboard looks like:

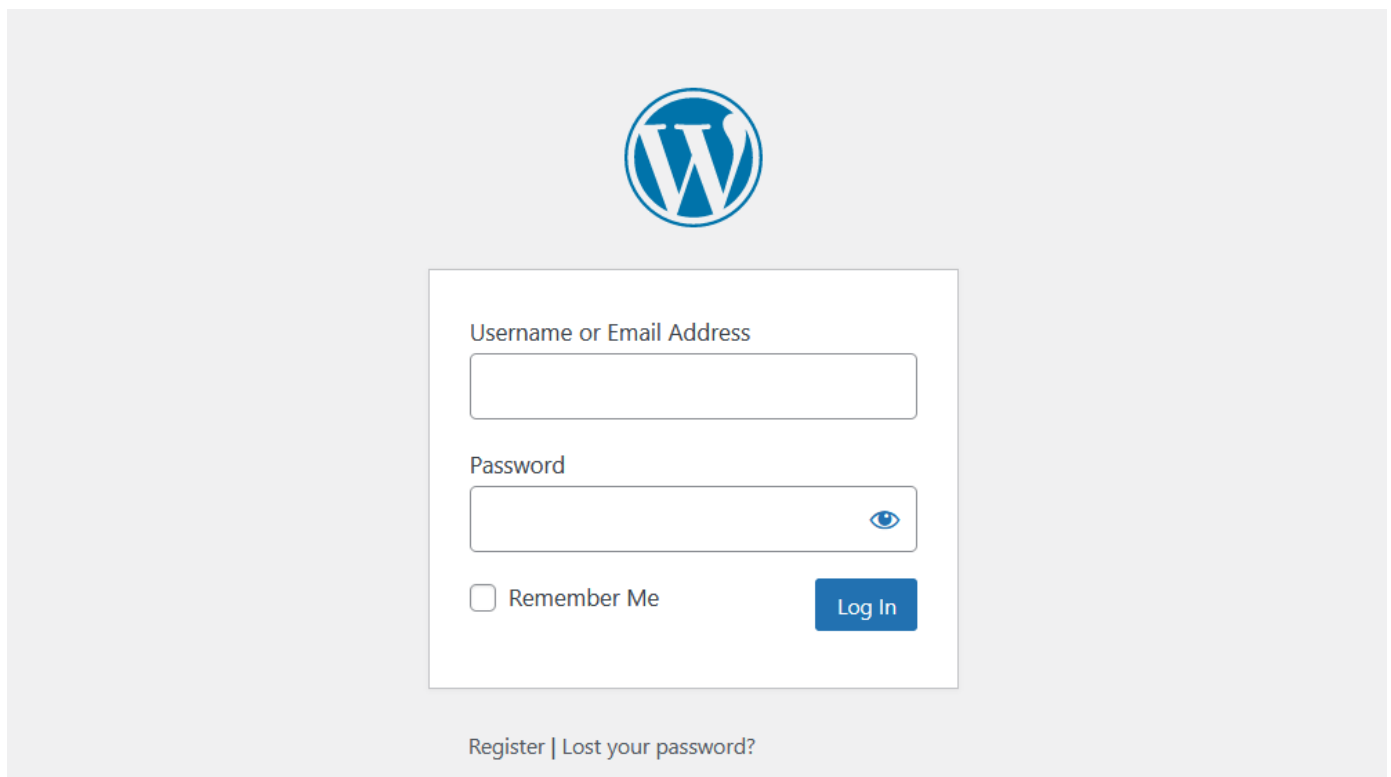


At a quick glance, you can see two menus. The menu to the left includes most of the configuration and publishing tools that you’ll use on a day-to-day basis. At the top of the screen, there’s a navigation menu that enables you to jump back and forth between the front end and the dashboard.

We'll talk about each option later in the post. For now, let's discuss how to log into the WordPress admin.

How do you access your WordPress admin dashboard?

When you install WordPress, the CMS automatically sets up an admin area for your website. You can access the dashboard by going to *yoursite.com/wp-admin*.

The image shows the WordPress login interface. At the top center is the WordPress logo, a blue circle with a white 'W'. Below the logo is a white rectangular form box. Inside the box, there are two input fields: the first is labeled 'Username or Email Address' and the second is labeled 'Password'. To the right of the password field is a small blue eye icon for toggling password visibility. Below the password field is a checkbox labeled 'Remember Me'. To the right of the checkbox is a blue button with the text 'Log In'. At the bottom of the form box, there are two links: 'Register' and 'Lost your password?'. The entire form is centered on a light gray background.

If you set up WordPress manually, you'll create an admin user during that process, with a username and password. These are the same credentials you'll use to log into your website and gain access to the WordPress admin panel.

Depending on your web hosting provider, they might set up WordPress for you. In that case, you might be able to choose your admin credentials during the signup process.

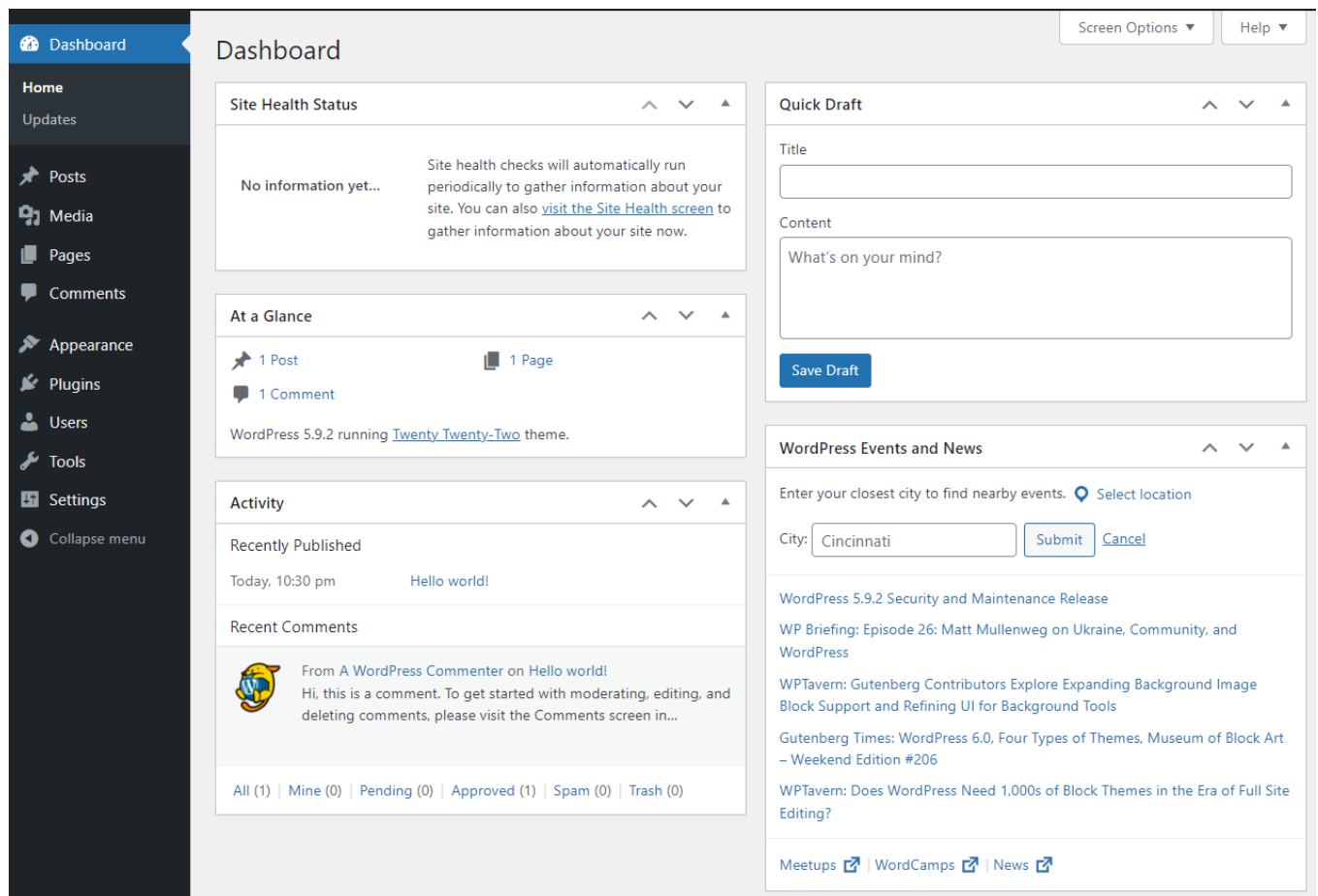
Keep in mind that you may not be the only user with access to the dashboard. As the administrator, you can enable registration and provide users with access to some of the same tools and configuration options on your site.

If you lose access to WordPress, you can use the login screen to reset the password — as long as you have access to the email associated with that account.

Understanding the WordPress admin interface and menu

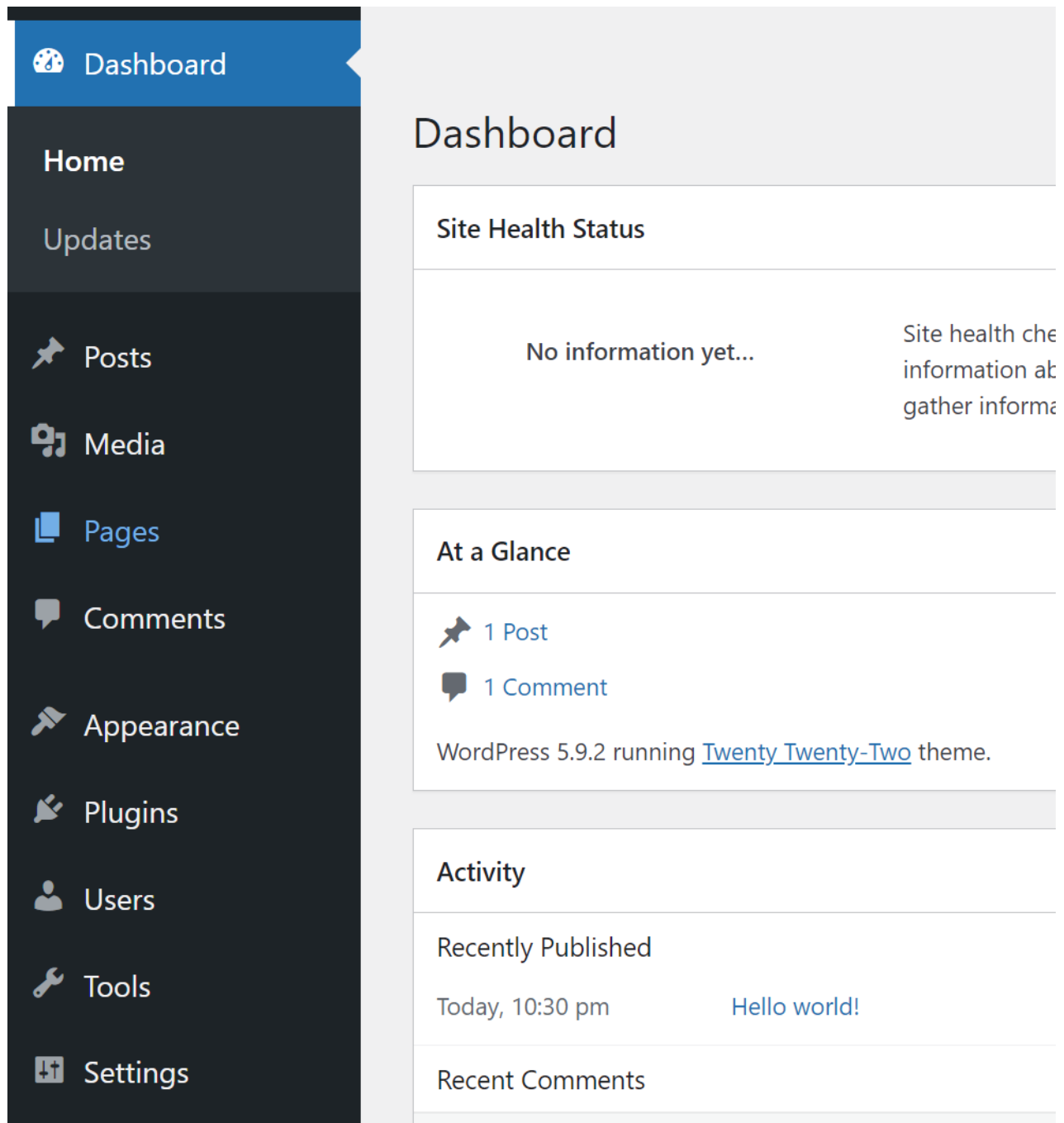
By default, the WordPress admin includes a broad number of links and tools. Although you may not use all of them on a daily basis, it's essential that you understand where to go for each task.

As soon as you log into WordPress, you'll see the **Home** screen under the **Dashboard** section.



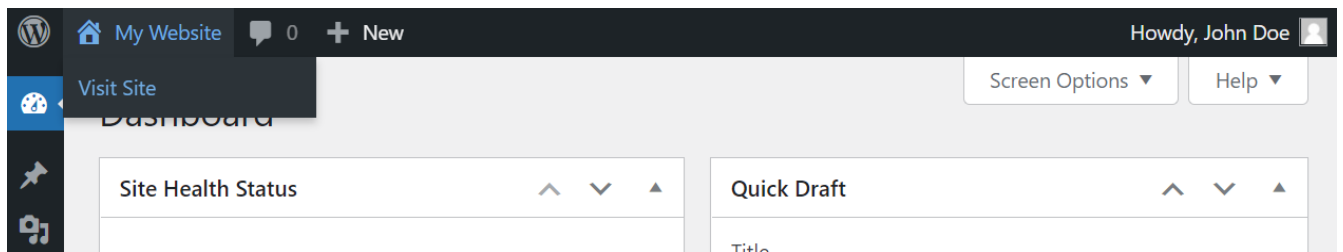
The **Home** page tells you how many pages, posts, and comments your website contains. You'll also see notifications about site health, comment activity, and WordPress news and events. If you want, you can even use the **Quick Draft** option to create and save content without leaving the page.

For the majority of users, the **Home** page is just a pit stop. You'll spend most of the time using the menu to the left of the screen. This menu includes options for publishing content, reviewing existing posts and pages, checking comments, managing plugins and themes, and more.



You'll also notice a main navigation menu at the top of the screen. This menu enables you to jump to the comments queue or the WordPress editor.

The menu's primary functionality, though, is to help you jump back and forth between your site's front end and the WordPress admin. If you hover over the name of your site, you'll see the **Visit Site** option.



Clicking on **Visit Site** will send you to your site's homepage. If you're logged in while browsing the website, the main navigation menu will still appear at the top of the screen.

You can hover over your site's name and you'll see options to return to the dashboard home or to the themes screen. The menu also includes an **Edit site** button, which will open the WordPress customizer.



If you're not sure what some of those options do, don't worry. We'll cover each component within the WordPress admin in the next section.

How to use your WordPress admin dashboard (15 steps)

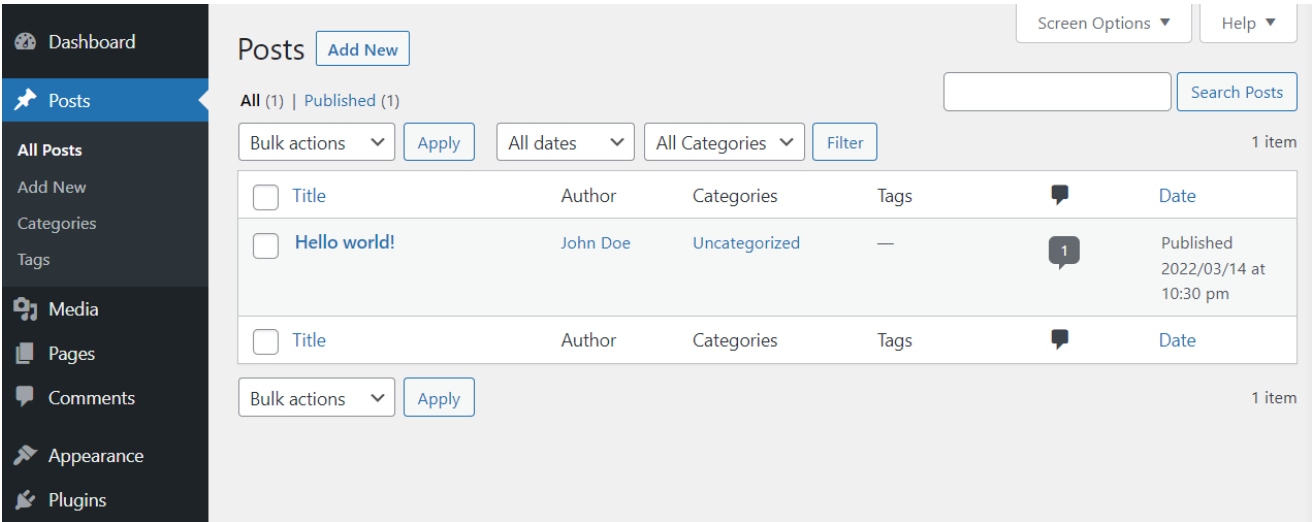
The WordPress dashboard can be intimidating at first due to the number of options that it contains. Your main point of interest while using the dashboard will be the left-side menu.

In this section, we'll walk you through the different options that you'll find in the menu. This way, you'll know where to start when you want to take any specific action on your website.

1. How to create and manage pages and posts

Creating and managing pages and posts is one of the main things you'll be doing in WordPress. If you take a look at the left-side menu in the admin, you'll see two options called **Pages** and **Posts**.

Selecting either option will send you to a page that lists every page or post that you've created. This includes published content, drafts, and even a trash bin for pages that you decide to delete.



This list of posts includes information about each entry's author, category, tags, comments, and publish date. You can also hover over individual entries to see editing options.

☐	Title	Author	Categories	Tags	
☐	Hello world! Edit Quick Edit Trash View	John Doe	Uncategorized	—	
☐	Title	Author	Categories	Tags	

When you hover over a page or a post, you'll see options to launch the editor or do a quick edit. If you want to learn how to use the WordPress editor (also known as the Block Editor), we recommend that you check out the [official Gutenberg page](#).

The **Quick Edit** option will enable you to edit a post's basic settings without needing to access a new page.

The screenshot shows the 'Quick Edit' modal in WordPress. At the top, there are tabs for 'Title', 'Author', 'Categories', 'Tags', and 'Date'. The 'Title' tab is active. Below the tabs, the 'QUICK EDIT' section contains several fields: 'Title' (Hello world!), 'Slug' (hello-world), 'Date' (03-Mar 14, 2022 at 22:30), 'Password' (empty), and 'Status' (Published). There are also checkboxes for 'Allow Comments', 'Allow Pings', and 'Make this post sticky'. A 'Categories' sidebar shows 'Uncategorized' selected. At the bottom, there are 'Cancel' and 'Update' buttons.

If you select multiple posts, you can use the **Bulk actions** menu above the list of entries. This menu offers options for editing multiple posts or moving them to the trash bin.

The screenshot shows the 'Posts' list table in WordPress. At the top, there are 'Screen Options' and 'Help' dropdowns. Below them is a search bar and a 'Search Posts' button. The table has columns for 'Title', 'Author', 'Categories', 'Tags', and 'Date'. A 'Bulk actions' dropdown menu is open, showing options: 'Bulk actions', 'Edit', and 'Move to Trash'. The 'Move to Trash' option is highlighted. The table shows one post titled 'Hello world!' by 'alexchiguire' in the 'Uncategorized' category, published on 2022/03/14 at 10:30 pm. At the bottom, there are 'Bulk actions' and 'Apply' buttons.

If you accumulate a large content library, you'll want to use the search and filter tools to navigate. You can filter posts by dates and categories, or use the search bar to find specific entries.

All dates ▾
All Categories ▾
Filter

1 item

	Categories	Tags		Date
John Doe	Uncategorized	—	1	Published 2022/03/14 at 10:30 pm

Author
Categories
Tags

Date

1 item

In the example above, we showed you the **Posts** → **All Posts** page. You'll find the same exact settings if you navigate to **Pages** → **All Pages** in the dashboard.

To add a new page or post to your website, go to **Posts** → **Add New** or **Pages** → **Add New**. Either option will launch the Block Editor. You can also navigate to the main **Posts** or **Pages** screen and click on the **Add New** button.

From a practical standpoint, creating and managing posts and pages in WordPress works much the same. The difference is that you're dealing with two types of content.

2. How to create and manage WordPress categories and tags

WordPress uses a taxonomy system to help you classify posts. This system consists of categories and tags. Categories are broader classifications, whereas tags are more specific.

To give you an idea, this article could fall under the *WordPress Tutorials* category. You might also want to assign it tags like *WordPress Dashboard*, *WordPress Login*, and more.

You can create as many categories and tags as you want and apply them to posts in any combination that you see fit. To start, go to **Posts** → **Categories**. Here, you'll see a list of existing categories and a menu that enables you to add new ones.

Categories

Screen Options ▾ Help ▾

Search Categories

Add New Category

Name

The name is how it appears on your site.

Slug

The "slug" is the URL-friendly version of the name. It is usually all lowercase and contains only letters, numbers, and hyphens.

Parent Category

None ▾

Categories, unlike tags, can have a hierarchy. You might have a Jazz category, and under that have children categories for Bebop and Big Band. Totally optional.

Description

The description is not prominent by default; however, some themes may show it.

Add New Category

Bulk actions ▾ Apply

1 item

☐	Name	Description	Slug	Count
	Uncategorized	—	uncategorized	1

Bulk actions ▾ Apply

1 item

Deleting a category does not delete the posts in that category. Instead, posts that were only assigned to the deleted category are set to the default category **Uncategorized**. The default category cannot be deleted.

Categories can be selectively converted to tags using the [category to tag converter](#).

To add a new category, select a name for it. You can also write a short description and choose for it to fall under a parent category, if desired.

Meanwhile, the slug is the URL-friendly version of the category name. If you have a category called *WordPress Tutorials*, the slug would be */wordpress-tutorials* or something similar.

When you add a category, you'll see it appear on the list to the right. To assign a category to a post, you'll need to use the editor.

Search Categories

Bulk actions ▼

Apply

1 item

☐	Name	Description	Slug	Count
☐	WordPress Tutorials	—	wordpress-tutorials	0
	Uncategorized	—	uncategorized	1

Bulk actions ▼

Apply

1 item

Moving on to the **Tags** page, the process for creating and managing WordPress tags works exactly the same. You get to select a name and a slug, and set a description for each tag that you add.

Tags

Screen Options ▼

Help ▼

Add New Tag

Name

The name is how it appears on your site.

Slug

The "slug" is the URL-friendly version of the name. It is usually all lowercase and contains only letters, numbers, and hyphens.

Description

The description is not prominent by default; however, some themes may show it.

Add New Tag

☐

Name

Description

Slug

Count

No tags found.

☐

Name

Description

Slug

Count

Tags can be selectively converted to categories using the [tag to category converter](#).

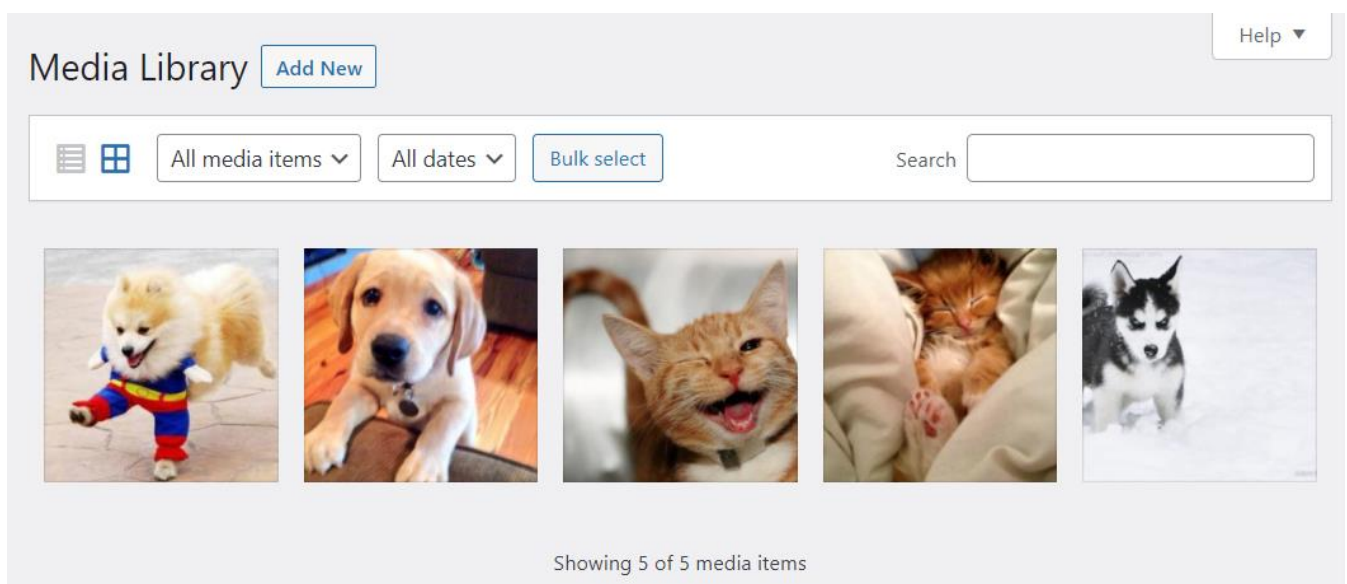
Just as with categories, you assign tags to posts through the editor.

Categories and tags make it simpler for visitors to navigate your content library and find related posts. As your content library grows, so should your website's taxonomy.

3. How to upload and manage media files

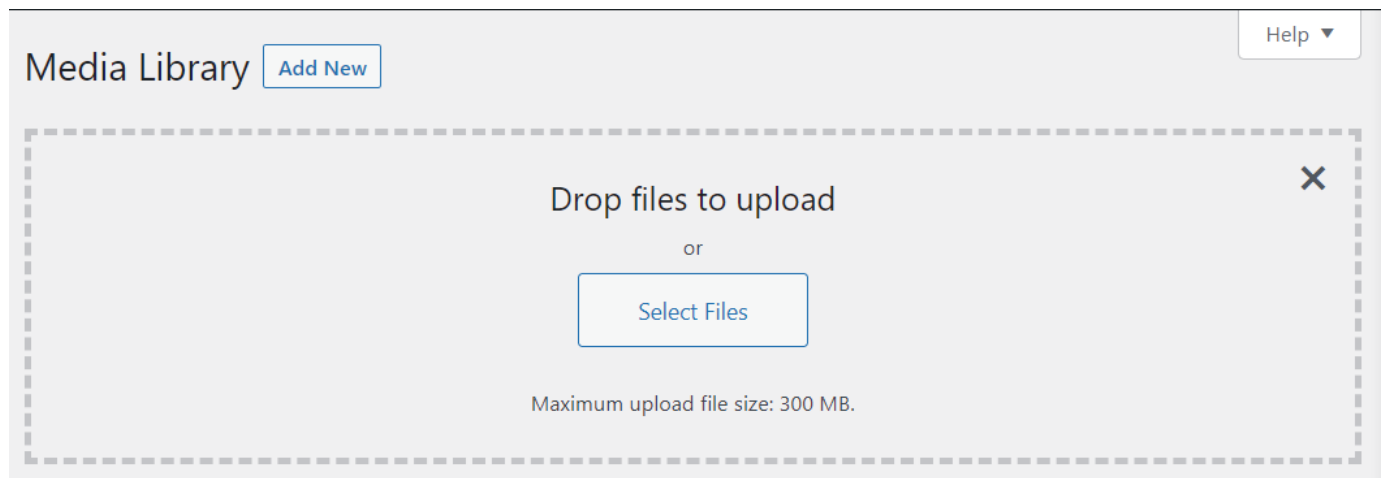
Media files are a key component of any website. WordPress supports a broad array of media file formats. So many, in fact, that we recommend you check out the official WordPress.org entry on [supported file types](#).

WordPress enables you to upload and display most of the popular image, video, and audio file types. You can do this using the WordPress media library, located under **Media** → **Library**.



The library provides you with an overview of every media file that you upload. You can upload files directly from the library using the **Add New** button or by clicking on **Media** → **Add New**.

When you upload a file, WordPress will ask you to either drag it into an upload "area" or use the **Select Files** option to browse your local files.



You can add multiple files at once, but there's a maximum upload file size. This size will depend on your web host and your site's configuration.

Once you upload your files, you can click on them within the media library. Clicking on any media file will display a details screen. This includes the file's name, its metadata, alt text, captions, descriptions, and URL.

Attachment details



Edit Image

Uploaded on: March 15, 2022
Uploaded by: [John Doe](#)
File name: 3hD48NZ.jpg
File type: image/jpeg
File size: 692 KB
Dimensions: 1836 by 2448 pixels

Alternative Text

[Learn how to describe the purpose of the image.](#) Leave empty if the image is purely decorative.

Title

3hD48NZ

Caption

Description

File URL:

<http://mywebsite.com/wp-co>

[Copy URL to clipboard](#)

[View attachment page](#) | [Edit more details](#) | [Delete permanently](#)

You can use the **Attachment details** screen to edit any media file's metadata. For images, you'll also see an **Edit Image** option at the bottom of the screen. Selecting this option will open a basic image editor.

WordPress' built-in image editor includes options for cropping, rotating, flipping, and resizing images. For every image that you upload, WordPress also creates a thumbnail, which you can resize from this screen as well.

Attachment details

 Crop  Rotate left  Rotate right  Flip vertical

 Flip horizontal

 Undo  Redo



SCALE IMAGE ?

Original dimensions 1836 × 2448

New dimensions:

×

IMAGE CROP ?

Aspect ratio:

:

Selection:

×

THUMBNAIL SETTINGS ?



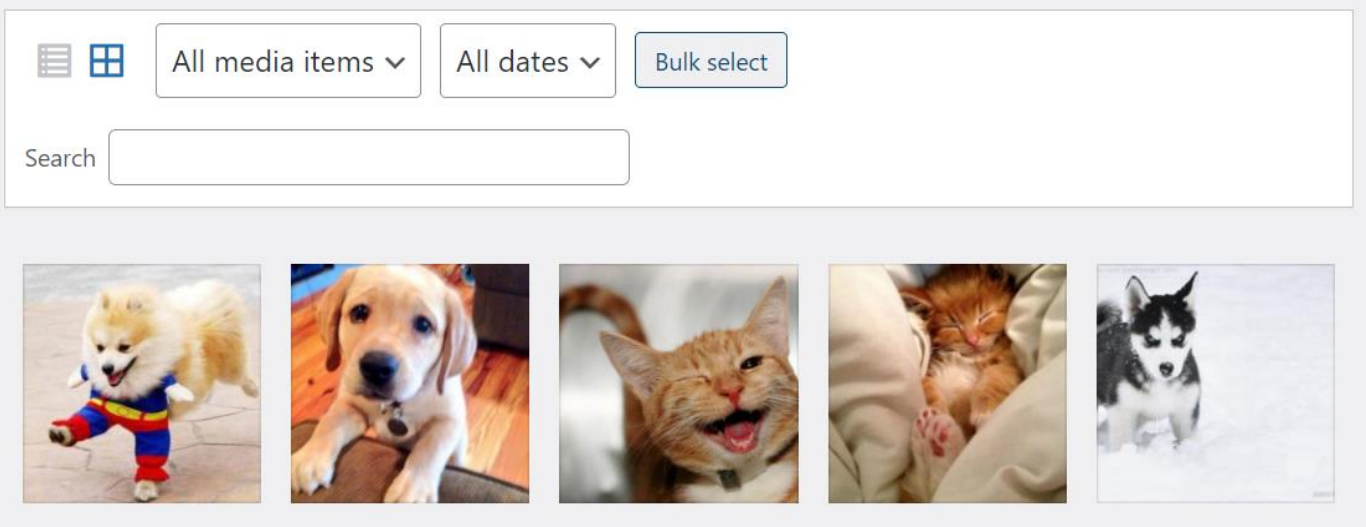
Current thumbnail

Apply changes to:

- ☒ All image sizes
☐ Thumbnail
☐ All sizes except thumbnail

When you're done editing, click on the **Save** button to save your changes. When it comes to audio and video, you can also edit metadata and play the files. Note that WordPress doesn't come with video or audio editing functionality.

As your site's media library grows, you may need to rely on the admin's filtering tools. The **Library** page enables you to sort files by type and date. You can also use a search tool and bulk select files to edit or delete them.



Note that there's no limit to how many media files you can upload to WordPress. The only limitation you might face is with your hosting plan's storage settings. To save space and run a more efficient site, you should occasionally [clean up your media library](#) to remove unused files.

Quick note: If you try to upload a file type that WordPress doesn't support, the admin will return an error.

4. How to manage WordPress comments

Since WordPress was designed to be a blogging platform, it comes with a [robust comments system](#). If you enable the comments feature, users will be able to write responses to posts and pages.

One response to “Hello world!”



A WordPress Commenter says:

March 14, 2022 at 10:30 pm [Edit](#)

Hi, this is a comment.

To get started with moderating, editing, and deleting comments, please visit the Comments screen in the dashboard.

Commenter avatars come from [Gravatar](#).

[Reply](#)

Leave a Reply

[Logged in as alexchiguire.](#) [Log out?](#) Required fields are marked *

Comment *

Post Comment

WordPress gives you full control over your comments. First off, you’ll want to familiarize yourself with the **Comments** page. There, you’ll find every comment published on your website, including its status.

Comments in WordPress can be approved, pending, trashed, or marked as spam. By default, WordPress has some spam recognition capabilities, but it will fall on you to filter and approve comments.

Screen Options ▾

Help ▾

Comments

All (1) | Mine (0) | Pending (0) | Approved (1) | Spam (0) | Trash (0)

Bulk actions ▾

All comment types ▾

1 item

☐	Author	Comment	In response to	Submitted on
☐	 A WordPress Commenter wordpress.org wapuu@wordpress.example	Hi, this is a comment. To get started with moderating, editing, and deleting comments, please visit the Comments screen in the dashboard. Commenter avatars come from Gravatar.	Hello world! View Post 1	2022/03/14 at 10:30 pm
☐	Author	Comment	In response to	Submitted on

Bulk actions ▾

1 item

To configure your site's comment settings, go to **Settings** → **Discussion**. This page includes multiple comment settings as well as configurations for your regular posts.

The **Allow people to submit comments on new posts** option will determine whether visitors can leave comments at all. Disabling that setting will disable the entire commenting system.

Help ▾

Discussion Settings

Default post settings

☒ Attempt to notify any blogs linked to from the post
 ☒ Allow link notifications from other blogs (pingbacks and trackbacks) on new posts
 ☒ Allow people to submit comments on new posts

Individual posts may override these settings. Changes here will only be applied to new posts.

If you enable that setting, scroll down to the **Other comment settings** section. Here, you'll be able to configure the information users must share to comment and if they need to register to do so.

This section also includes options for automatically closing comment sections, controlling cookies, enabling nested comments, and adding pagination to comments.

Other comment settings	☒	Comment author must fill out name and email
	☐	Users must be registered and logged in to comment
	☐	Automatically close comments on posts older than 14 days
	☒	Show comments cookies opt-in checkbox, allowing comment author cookies to be set
	☒	Enable threaded (nested) comments 5 levels deep
	☐	Break comments into pages with
	50	top level comments per page and the
	last	page displayed by default
Comments should be displayed with the older comments at the top of each page		

The **Discussion** settings also include options for receiving notifications when visitors leave a comment, or if there are entries that you need to moderate. If you check out the **Before a comment appears** section, you'll be able to configure whether comments require manual approval.

There's also an option that enables users with previously-approved comments to skip the moderation queue.

Email me whenever	☒	Anyone posts a comment
	☒	A comment is held for moderation
Before a comment appears	☐	Comment must be manually approved
	☒	Comment author must have a previously approved comment

To make moderation easier, WordPress includes a feature that enables you to automatically flag comments that include specific words or identifying data, like usernames, emails, or IP addresses.

Comment Moderation

Hold a comment in the queue if it contains or more links. (A common characteristic of comment spam is a large number of hyperlinks.)

When a comment contains any of these words in its content, author name, URL, email, IP address, or browser's user agent string, it will be held in the [moderation queue](#). One word or IP address per line. It will match inside words, so "press" will match "WordPress".

Disallowed Comment Keys

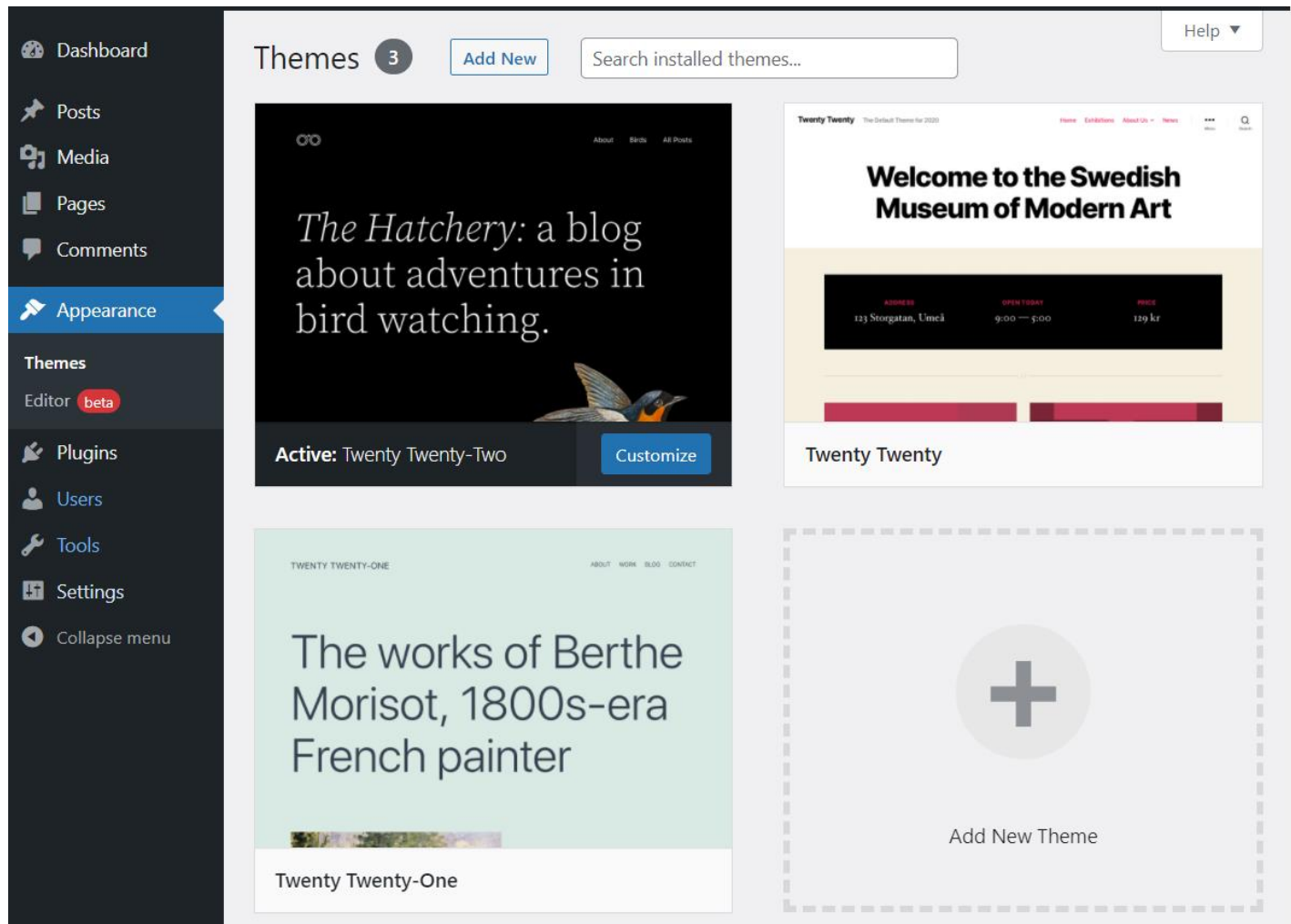
When a comment contains any of these words in its content, author name, URL, email, IP address, or browser's user agent string, it will be put in the Trash. One word or IP address per line. It will match inside words, so "press" will match "WordPress".

The default WordPress comment system works fairly well, but it can struggle to filter spam as your site becomes more popular. Consider installing a [plugin to stop comment spam on WordPress](#).

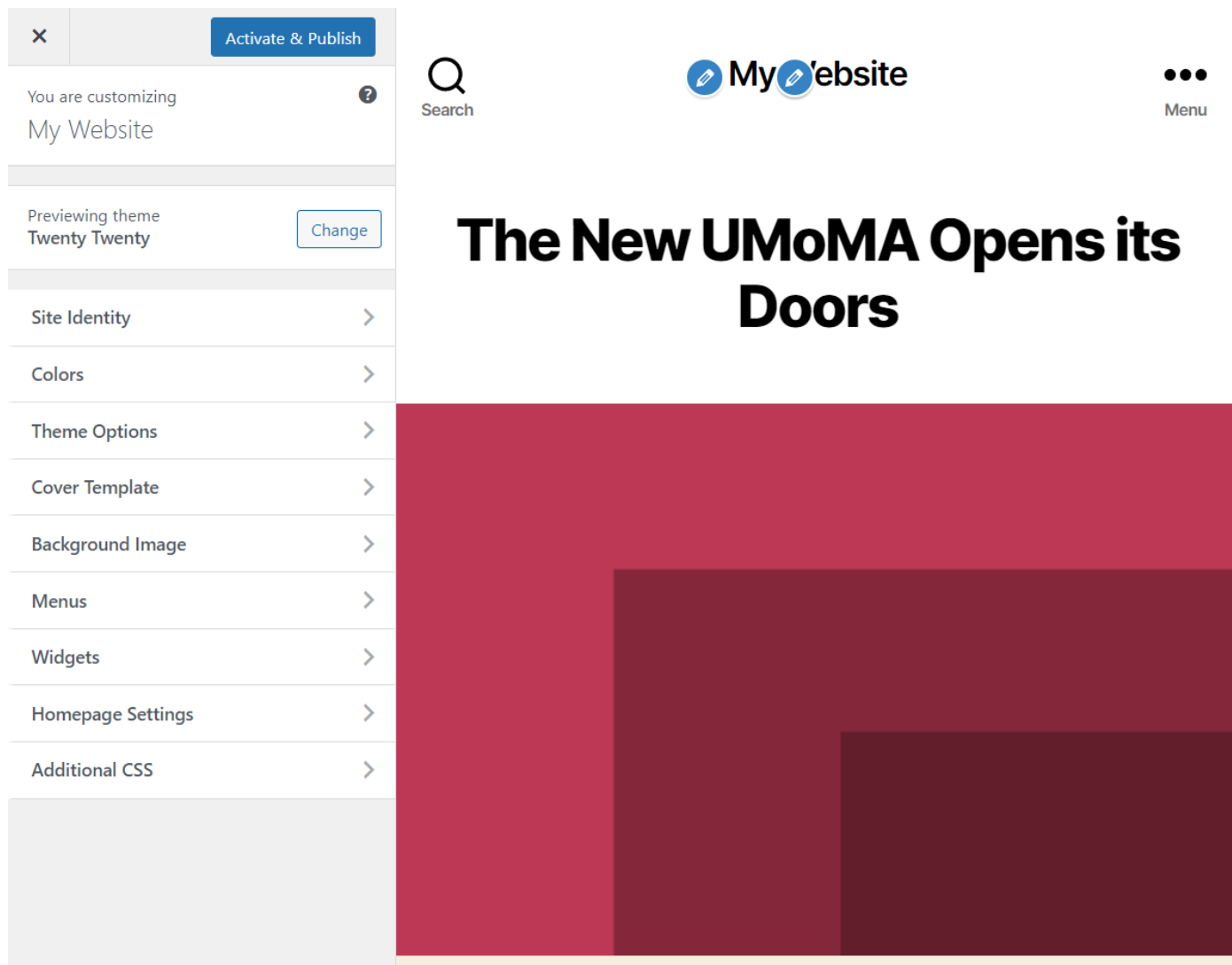
5. How to manage your website's appearance

The **Appearance** menu in the WP admin dashboard enables you to choose which theme to use. You can also use this menu to launch the WordPress full-site editor.

To choose a theme, go to **Appearance** → **Themes**. Out of the box, WordPress ships with a handful of default themes.



You can select any of them and switch to one by hovering over the selection and clicking on **Activate**.



The preview feature enables you to customize the theme's style so you can see if it's a good fit for your needs. If a theme doesn't meet your standards, you can always look for new options.

Return to the **Themes** tab and click on **Add New** or **Add New Theme**. Doing so will load the WordPress.org theme repository. The repository is a massive collection of themes, all of them free.

Add Themes

Upload Theme

Help ▾

4722

Popular

Latest

Favorites

⚙️ Feature Filter

Search themes...

✓ Installed

The Hatchery: a blog about adventures in bird watching.

Twenty Twenty-Two

Activated

Customize

✓ Installed

The works of Berthe Morisot, 1800s-era French painter

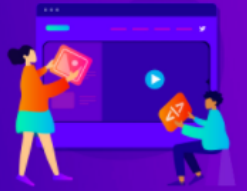
Twenty Twenty-One

ASTRA

Home About Services Reviews FAQ Contact

Your Idea Matters!

Make a Website



Local Business

Similique nctio asim

eCommerce

Lique distotio assum

Blogging

Milique disto catio os

Professional Services

Milique disto qjvotio os

Astra

IE

Hello

Theme

I am text block. Click edit button to change this text. Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Ut elit tellus, luctus nec ullamcorper mattis, pulvinar dapibus leo.

Launch Project →



Lorem ipsum is simply dummy text. There are many variations of

Where does it come from? Contrary

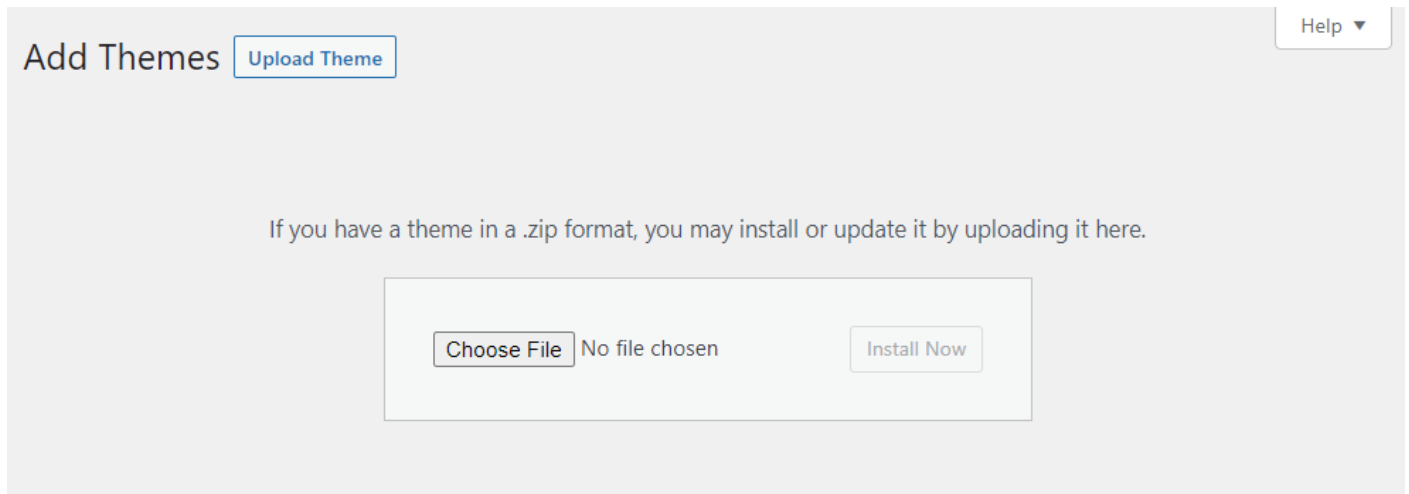
Here are many variations of

Hello Elementor

From here, you can select any theme that you like and click on either **Install** or **Preview**. The preview feature will enable you to check out the theme before installing it.

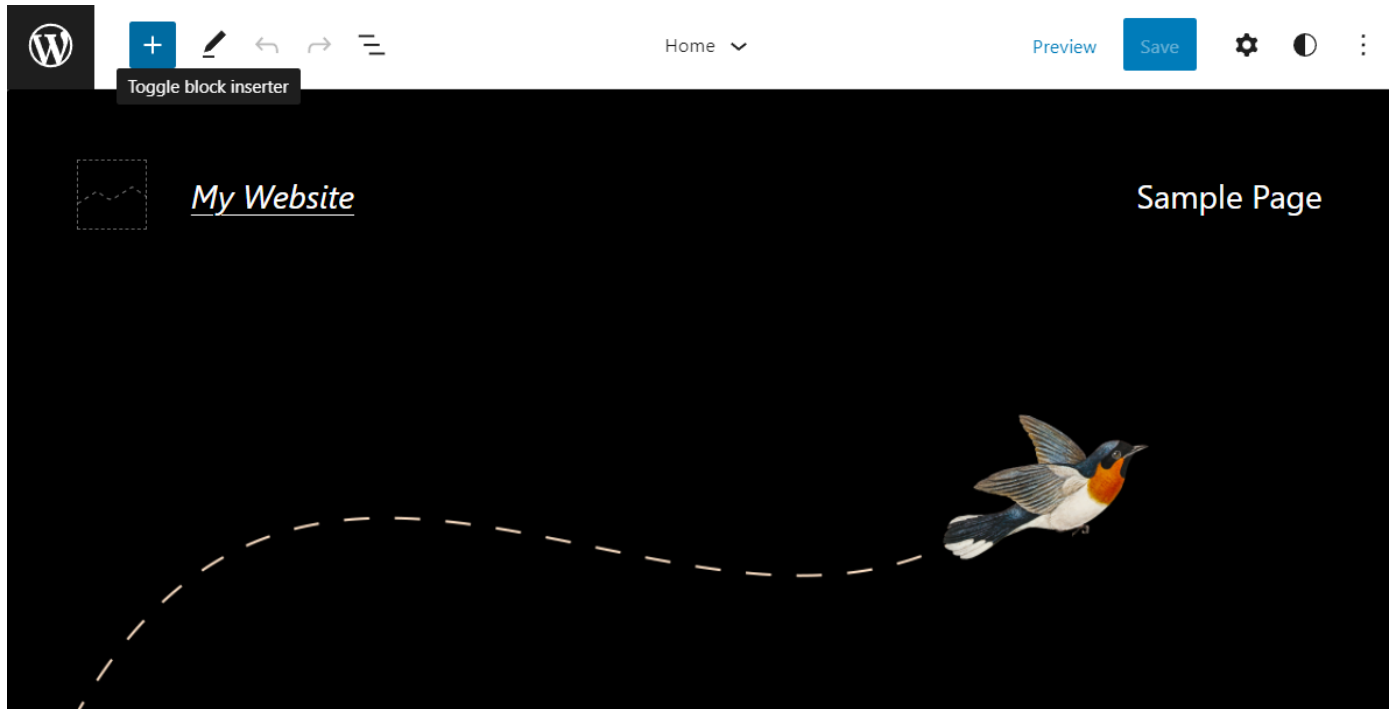
If you want to upload theme files directly, you can do so using the **Upload Theme** button. Clicking on this option will enable you to upload themes in .zip format.

This is the route you'll want to take if you purchase a premium theme from another source.



After you install a theme, it will appear under the **Appearance** → **Themes** menu as a part of your collection. You can install as many themes as you like, but you can only use one at a time.

If you go to **Appearance** → **Editor**, you'll launch the WordPress full-site editor. Full-site editing is a relatively new feature in WordPress. It enables you to edit your theme templates using the Block Editor.



Hello world!

[Learn more about the full site editor.](#)

6. How to manage plugins and tools

There are thousands of WordPress plugins to choose from. Each plugin adds one (or several) new features and tools to the CMS, which is one of the reasons why WordPress is so incredibly popular.

When you launch a new website, your web host might pre-install some plugins for you. To see what plugins you have installed, go to **Plugins → Installed Plugins**.

Plugins

Add New

All (1) | Active (1) | Auto-updates Disabled (1)

Bulk actions

▼

Apply

☐ Plugin

Description

Automatic Upd

☐ **Jetpack**
[My Jetpack](#) | [Settings](#) | [Support](#) | [Deactivate](#)

Security, performance, and marketing tools made by WordPress experts. Jetpack keeps your site protected so you can focus on more important things.

Version 10.7 | [By Automattic](#) | [View details](#)

[Enable auto-upd](#)

☐ Plugin

Description

Automatic Upd

Bulk actions

▼

Apply

Inside, you'll find a list of installed, active, and inactive plugins. You can see basic information and enable automatic updates for each one.

If you have an inactive plugin that you want to activate, select the **Activate** option under its name. To disable a plugin, select the **Deactivate** option.

☐ Plugin	Description	Automatic Updates
☐ Akismet Anti-Spam Activate Delete	Used by millions, Akismet is quite possibly the best way in the world to protect your blog from spam . It keeps your site protected even while you sleep. To get started: activate the Akismet plugin and then go to your Akismet Settings page to set up your API key. Version 4.2.2 By Automattic View details	Enable auto-updates
☐ Jetpack My Jetpack Settings Support Deactivate	Security, performance, and marketing tools made by WordPress experts. Jetpack keeps your site protected so you can focus on more important things. Version 10.7 By Automattic View details	Disable auto-updates
☐ Plugin	Description	Automatic Updates

To add new plugins, click on **Add New** at the top of the screen. The WordPress admin will display the official plugin repository, which includes thousands of options to choose from.

Add Plugins

Upload Plugin

Help ▾

FeaturedPopularRecommendedFavorites

Keyword ▾Search plugins...

Plugins extend and expand the functionality of WordPress. You may automatically install plugins from the [WordPress Plugin Directory](#) or upload a plugin in .zip format by clicking the button at the top of this page.



Classic Editor

Install NowMore Details

Enables the previous "classic" editor and the old-style Edit Post screen with TinyMCE, Meta Boxes, etc. Supports all plugins that extend this screen.

By WordPress Contributors

★★★★★ (1,057)

5+ Million Active Installations

Last Updated: 8 months ago

Untested with your version of WordPress



Akismet Spam Protection

ActivateMore Details

The best anti-spam protection to block spam comments and spam in a contact form. The most trusted antispam solution for WordPress and WooCommerce.

By Automattic

★★★★★ (930)

5+ Million Active Installations

Last Updated: 2 months ago

✓ Compatible with your version of WordPress



Jetpack – WP Security, Backup, Speed, & Growth

ActiveMore Details

Improve your WP security with powerful one-click tools like backup and malware scan. Get essential free tools including stats, CDN and social sharing.

By Automattic

★★★★★ (1,743)

5+ Million Active Installations

Last Updated: 2 weeks ago

✓ Compatible with your version of WordPress



Classic Widgets

Install NowMore Details

Enables the previous "classic" widgets settings screens in Appearance - Widgets and the Customizer. Disables the block editor from managing widgets.

By WordPress Contributors

★★★★★ (200)

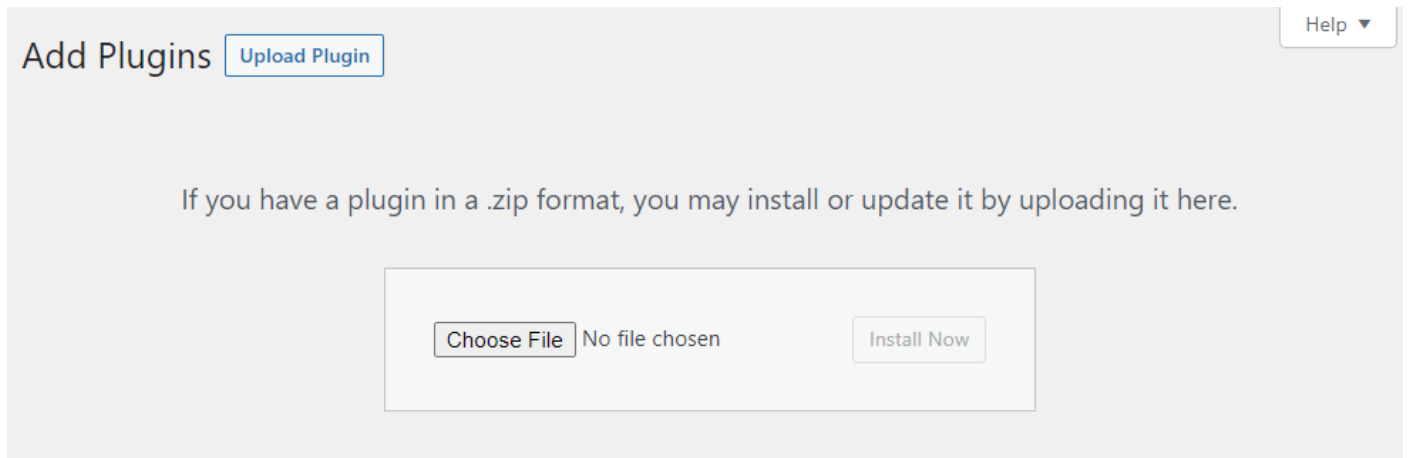
1+ Million Active Installations

Last Updated: 2 months ago

✓ Compatible with your version of WordPress

To install a plugin, click on **Install Now** and wait for WordPress to download its files. Once the plugin is ready, you can activate it by clicking on the **Activate** button.

You can also upload plugin files directly to WordPress. Click on **Upload Plugin** and WordPress will ask you to select the *.zip* file that you want to upload.



When it comes to plugins, we encourage you to research your options carefully. Not sure what to look for? Learn [how to select the best WordPress plugins](#) for your site.

7. How to manage WordPress updates

To keep your site working its best, you'll need to ensure that all of your site's components are up to date. This means updating WordPress core and any plugins and themes that you use.

Browsing the **Plugins** and **Themes** pages will reveal any plugins or themes that need to be updated. WordPress displays a notice showing how many plugins or themes you can update in the left-hand menu.

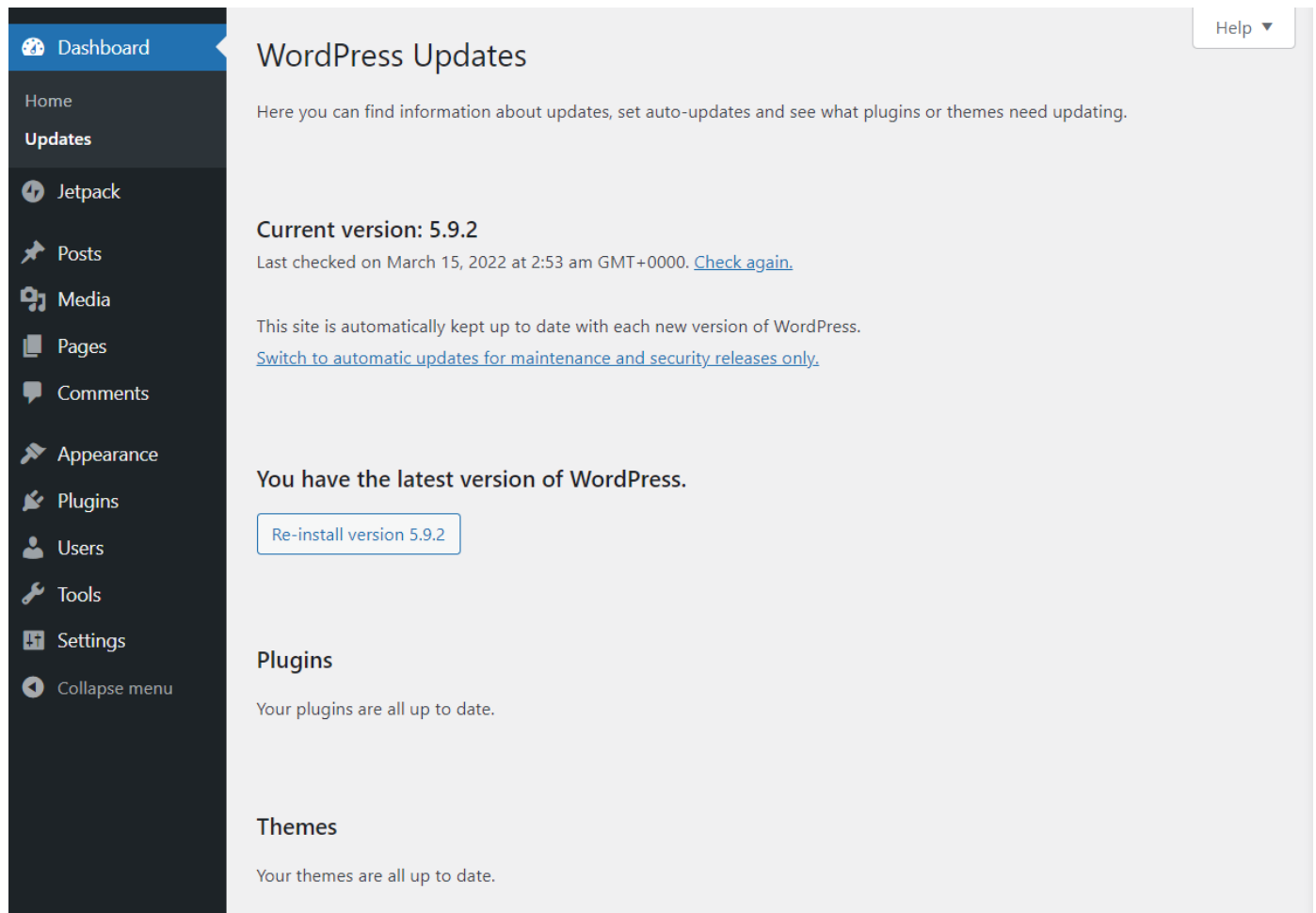
Updating plugins is simple. Identify the plugins that need updating and select the **update now** option that will appear under those entries.

☐	Gutenberg PDF Viewer Block Deactivate	A simple and 100% free Gutenberg Block to display PDF Viewers / Readers on your website. Version 0.1 By audrasjb View details	Enable
☐	Public Post Preview Deactivate	Allow anonymous users to preview a post before it is published. Version 2.8 By Dominik Schilling View details	Enable
There is a new version of Public Post Preview available. View version 2.9.0 details or update now .			
☐	Reusable Blocks Extended Deactivate	Extend Gutenberg Reusable Blocks feature with a complete admin panel, widgets, shortcodes and PHP functions. Version 0.5.1 By audrasjb View details	Auto-updates enabled Disable

WordPress will automatically download and install any necessary files. If you turn on auto-updates for a specific plugin, you won't need to remember to update it manually. You can turn on auto-updates by selecting the **Enable auto-updates** option to the right of any plugin entry.

☐ Plugin	Description	Automatic Updates
☐ Akismet Anti-Spam Activate Delete	Used by millions, Akismet is quite possibly the best way in the world to protect your blog from spam . It keeps your site protected even while you sleep. To get started: activate the Akismet plugin and then go to your Akismet Settings page to set up your API key. Version 4.2.2 By Automattic View details	Enable auto-updates
☐ Jetpack My Jetpack Settings Support Deactivate	Security, performance, and marketing tools made by WordPress experts. Jetpack keeps your site protected so you can focus on more important things. Version 10.7 By Automattic View details	Enable auto-updates
☐ Plugin	Description	Automatic Updates

If you want a full overview of every site component that requires an update, go to **Dashboard** → **Updates**. This page will provide a list of any plugins or themes that require updates. You'll also find out if there are new versions of WordPress available.



Typically, it's very hard to miss available updates if you check the WordPress admin panel on a regular basis. If you keep up with updates, your site will be much more secure.

8. How to manage user accounts in WordPress

By default, WordPress will assign you an administrator account when you create a website. WordPress itself comes with a comprehensive user system that includes multiple types of roles, including:

- Administrator
- Author
- Editor

- Contributor
- Subscriber

The options you have access to in the WordPress dashboard will depend on your user role. As the site's owner, you should be the only user with full access to every setting and page within the dashboard.

If you visit the **Users** → **All Users** page, you'll see an overview of every existing user account.

The screenshot shows the 'All Users' page in the WordPress dashboard. At the top, there's a 'Users' header with an 'Add New' button. Below this, there's a filter bar showing 'All (1) | Administrator (1)' and a search box labeled 'Search Users'. A table lists the users, with columns for 'Username', 'Name', 'Email', 'Role', and 'Posts'. One user is listed: John Doe, an Administrator with 1 post. Below the table, there are bulk action controls including 'Bulk actions', 'Apply', 'Change role to...', and 'Change' buttons, with a '1 item' indicator.

☐	Username	Name	Email	Role	Posts
☐	John Doe	—	johndoe@email.com	Administrator	1

To add a new user account, click on **Add New** at the top of the screen or go to **Users** → **Add New** from the left-hand menu. In the next screen, you can set a username, email, first and last name, a website, and a password for the new account.

Add New User

Create a brand new user and add them to this site.

Username (required)

Email (required)

First Name

Last Name

Website

Password

Generate password

kbh0tBR1\$hp&YhwQW5Ru0z6



Hide

Strong

Send User Notification



Send the new user an email about their account.

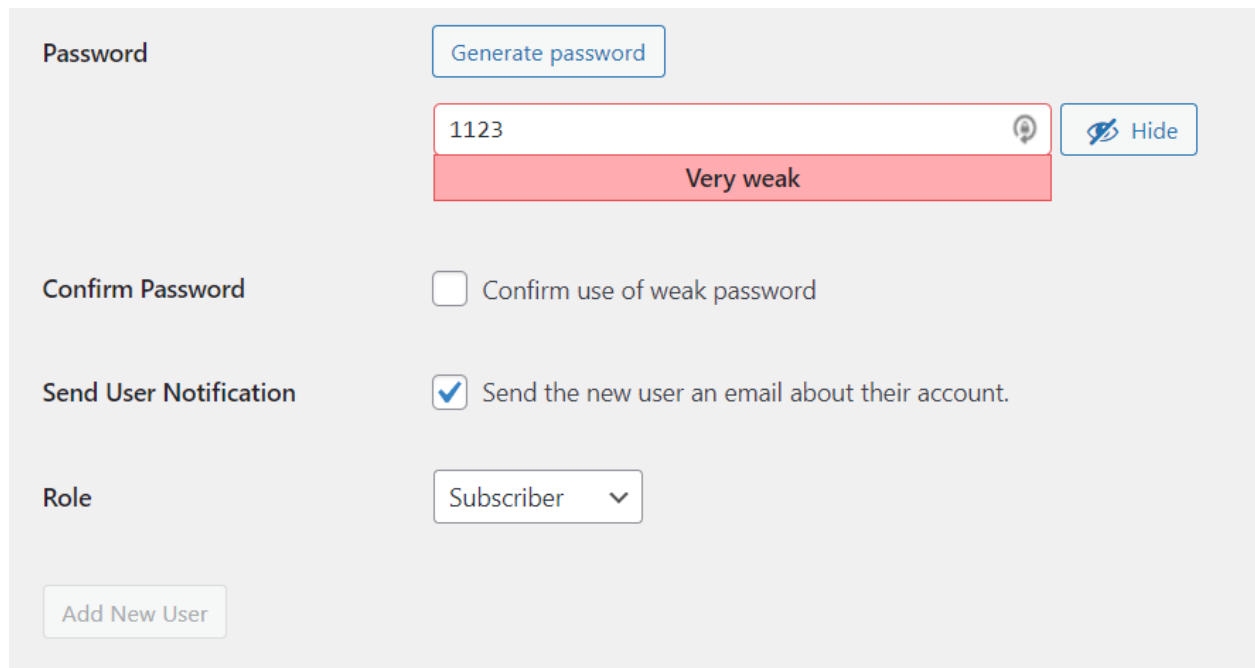
Role

Subscriber ▼

Add New User

By default, WordPress only requires you to enter a username and an email. It will automatically send a notification to that email if you leave the **Send User Notification** option turned on.

WordPress will also generate strong passwords for new accounts. If it detects a weak password, it will ask you to confirm if you want to use it.

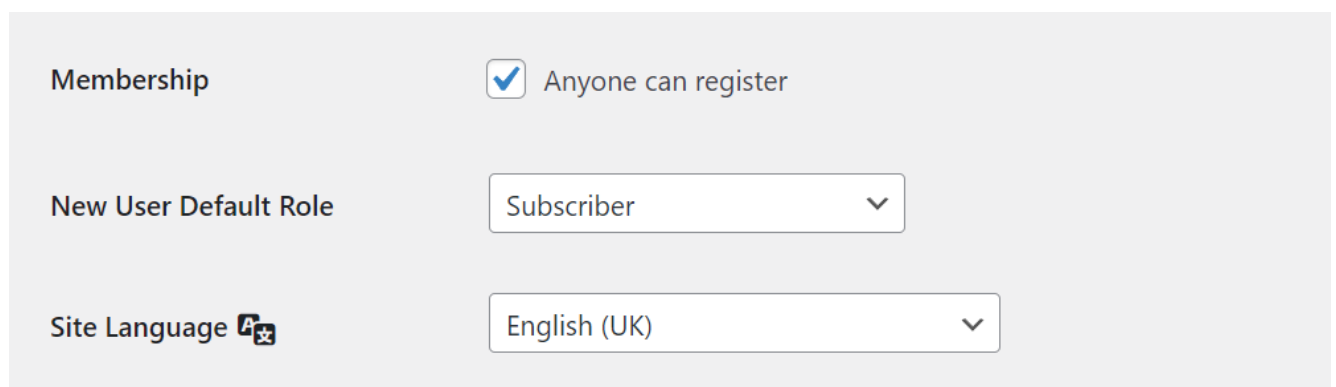


The screenshot shows the 'Add New User' form in WordPress. It includes a 'Password' field with a 'Generate password' button and a 'Hide' button. The password '1123' is entered, and a red banner below it indicates 'Very weak'. There is a 'Confirm Password' field with a checkbox to 'Confirm use of weak password'. The 'Send User Notification' checkbox is checked, with the text 'Send the new user an email about their account.' The 'Role' dropdown menu is set to 'Subscriber'. At the bottom is an 'Add New User' button.

You can use the **Role** menu to assign a user role to the new account. Once the fields are all ready, click on **Add New User**.

If you don't want to add user accounts manually, you can [enable registration on your website](#). This way, visitors will be able to use a pre-built form.

To turn on that setting, go to **Settings** → **General** and tick the **Anyone can register** option next to **Membership**. From here, you can also designate a default role for new users,



The screenshot shows the 'Settings - General' page in WordPress. The 'Membership' section has the 'Anyone can register' checkbox checked. The 'New User Default Role' dropdown menu is set to 'Subscriber'. The 'Site Language' dropdown menu is set to 'English (UK)'.

9. How to configure WordPress settings

The bulk of the configuration options for your WordPress website lie within the **Settings** menu. We've already covered the **Discussion** settings. Let's look at what other options are available.

10. WordPress General Settings

The WordPress **General Settings** screen enables you to set a title for a website and to configure its URLs. You can also update your admin email from this page and enable user registration.

General Settings

Help ▼

Site Title

My Website

Tagline

Just another WordPress site

In a few words, explain what this site is about.

WordPress Address (URL)

http://mywebsite.com

Site Address (URL)

http://mywebsite.com

Enter the address here if you [want your site home page to be different from your WordPress installation directory](#).

Administration Email Address

contact@wordcandy.co

This address is used for admin purposes. If you change this, we will send you an email at your new address to confirm it. **The new address will not become active until confirmed.**

Membership

☒ Anyone can register

If you scroll down, you'll see options for changing your site's language. This will switch the language that the WordPress admin uses. You can also update timezones, switch date and time formats, and set when the week starts.

Site Language  English (UK) ▼

Time zone UTC+0 ▼

Choose either a city in the same time zone as you or a UTC (Coordinated Universal Time) time offset.

Universal time is 15 March 2022 03:05 .

Date Format

☐ 15 March 2022 j F Y

☐ 2022-03-15 Y-m-d

☐ 03/15/2022 m/d/Y

☐ 15/03/2022 d/m/Y

☒ Custom: F j, Y

Preview: March 15, 2022

Time Format

☐ 03:05 H:i

☐ 3:05 AM g:i A

☒ Custom: g:i a

Preview: 3:05 am

[Documentation on date and time formatting.](#)

Week Starts On Monday ▼

[Save Changes](#)

When you're happy with the changes that you made, click on the **Save Changes** button. You should only need to configure general settings once.

11. WordPress Writing Settings

The **Settings** → **Writing** screen enables you to configure the default post formats and categories. Changing default post formats can help if you use custom post types.

Writing Settings

[Help ▼](#)

Default Post Category

Uncategorized ▼

Default Post Format

Standard ▼

WordPress also offers an interesting feature called **Post via email**. With this function, WordPress will automatically publish any posts that you send to a specific email address.

Post via email

To post to WordPress by email, you must set up a secret email account with POP3 access. Any mail received at this address will be posted, so it's a good idea to keep this address very secret. Here are three random strings you could use: `SjRTM70J`, `kpHIkC52`, `VmqUoRKY`.

Mail Server

mail.example.com



Port

110

Login Name

login@example.com

Password

password

Default Mail Category

Uncategorized ▼

Update Services

When you publish a new post, WordPress automatically notifies the following site update services. For more about this, see [Update Services](#) on the Codex. Separate multiple service URLs with line breaks.

http://rpc.pingomatic.com/

Save Changes

By and large, that may not be a feature that you'll use regularly. Every time that you publish a post, it should be carefully edited and formatted, which means using the Block Editor.

12. WordPress Reading Settings

The **Settings** → **Reading** screen is where you can designate the page you want to be your site's homepage. Under the heading **Your homepage displays**, you can choose between a collection of your site's latest posts or a static page.

Reading Settings

Help ▼

Your homepage displays

☐ Your latest posts

☒ A [static page](#) (select below)

Homepage:

Posts page:

If you scroll down, you can configure how many posts will appear on your blog pages. For older posts, users will need to navigate from page to page. You can also decide whether to display post excerpts or their full text in the blog feed.

Blog pages show at most

posts

Syndication feeds show the most recent

items

For each post in a feed, include

☒ Full text

☐ Excerpt

Your theme determines how content is displayed in browsers. [Learn more about feeds.](#)

Search engine visibility

☐ Discourage search engines from indexing this site

It is up to search engines to honour this request.

Finally, you can enable the **Discourage search engines from indexing this site** option if you want to prevent your website from appearing in Search Engine Results Pages (SERPs).

In most cases, you want to appear in the SERPs to get more traffic. You shouldn't discourage search engines from indexing your pages unless you have a good reason to do so (like wanting to run a private site).

13. WordPress Media Settings

The **Settings** → **Media** page includes options for configuring the default resolution for any new images that you upload. When you upload an image to WordPress, it automatically generates multiple copies of it in different sizes (in pixels).

Media Settings

Help ▼

Image sizes

The sizes listed below determine the maximum dimensions in pixels to use when adding an image to the Media Library.

Thumbnail size

Width

150

Height

150

☒ Crop thumbnail to exact dimensions (normally thumbnails are proportional)

Medium size

Max Width

300

Max Height

300

Large size

Max Width

1024

Max Height

1024 ▼

Uploading Files

☒ Organise my uploads into month- and year-based folders

Save Changes

WordPress does this so you can choose from those sizes when inserting images into posts. If you're not happy with any of the default image resolutions, you can change their dimensions.

At the bottom of the screen, you'll find an option for WordPress to automatically organize your media files into date-based folders. These folders won't be apparent from inside the WordPress admin area. To see them, you'll need to connect to your website via File Transfer Protocol.

14. WordPress Permalink Settings

Permalinks are a key component of how WordPress works. When you publish a new page or post, it automatically generates a link. The URL's format depends on the permalink structure that you select.

To choose a structure, go to **Settings** → **Permalinks**. Inside, you'll find a selection of available URL structures. The custom part of the URL comes after the domain. In this example, that domain is *yourwebsite.com*.

Permalink Settings

WordPress offers you the ability to create a custom URL structure for your permalinks and archives. Custom URL structures can improve the aesthetics, usability, and forward-compatibility of your links. A [number of tags are available](#), and here are some examples to get you started.

Common Settings

☐ Plain	<code>http://yourwebsite.com/?p=123</code>
☒ Day and name	<code>http://yourwebsite.com/2022/03/15/sample-post/</code>
☐ Month and name	<code>http://yourwebsite.com/2022/03/sample-post/</code>
☐ Numeric	<code>http://yourwebsite.com/archives/123</code>
☐ Post name	<code>http://yourwebsite.com/sample-post/</code>
☐ Custom Structure	<code>http://yourwebsite.com</code> /%year%/%monthnum%/%day%/%postname%/ Available tags: %year% %monthnum% %day% %hour% %minute% %second% %post_id% %postname% %category% %author%

Ideally, you'll choose a URL format as soon as you create a new website. Changing permalink structures for a website that's been around for a while can lead to errors and affect your search engine rankings.

The most popular permalink structures for most websites are the **Post name** and **Month and name** options. They're both relatively short, and you can set the slug for each URL when editing that blog post or page.

If you use WooCommerce, the **Permalinks** page will also enable you to change the URL structure for online products. Note that the default options for WooCommerce don't include numbers or dates.

15. WordPress Privacy Settings

User privacy is incredibly important and WordPress offers a built-in tool to help you [generate a privacy policy page](#) for your website.

To access that tool, go to **Settings** → **Privacy**. If you select **Create a new Privacy Policy Page**, WordPress will automatically set up a new page with a template for you.

Privacy

SettingsPolicy Guide

The currently selected Privacy Policy page does not exist. Please create or select a new page.

Privacy Settings

As a website owner, you may need to follow national or international privacy laws. For example, you may need to create and display a Privacy Policy. If you already have a Privacy Policy page, please select it below. If not, please create one.

The new page will include help and suggestions for your Privacy Policy. However, it is your responsibility to use those resources correctly, to provide the information that your Privacy Policy requires, and to keep that information current and accurate.

After your Privacy Policy page is set, we suggest that you edit it. We would also suggest reviewing your Privacy Policy from time to time, especially after installing or updating any themes or plugins. There may be changes or new suggested information for you to consider adding to your policy.

Need help putting together your new Privacy Policy page? [Check out our Privacy Policy guide](#) for recommendations on what content to include, along with policies suggested by your plugins and theme.

Create a new Privacy Policy Page

Create

Select a Privacy Policy page

- Select -

Use This Page

The **Select a Privacy Policy** page option will enable you to choose one existing page and designate it as your site's policy. This means you get full control over its appearance and contents.

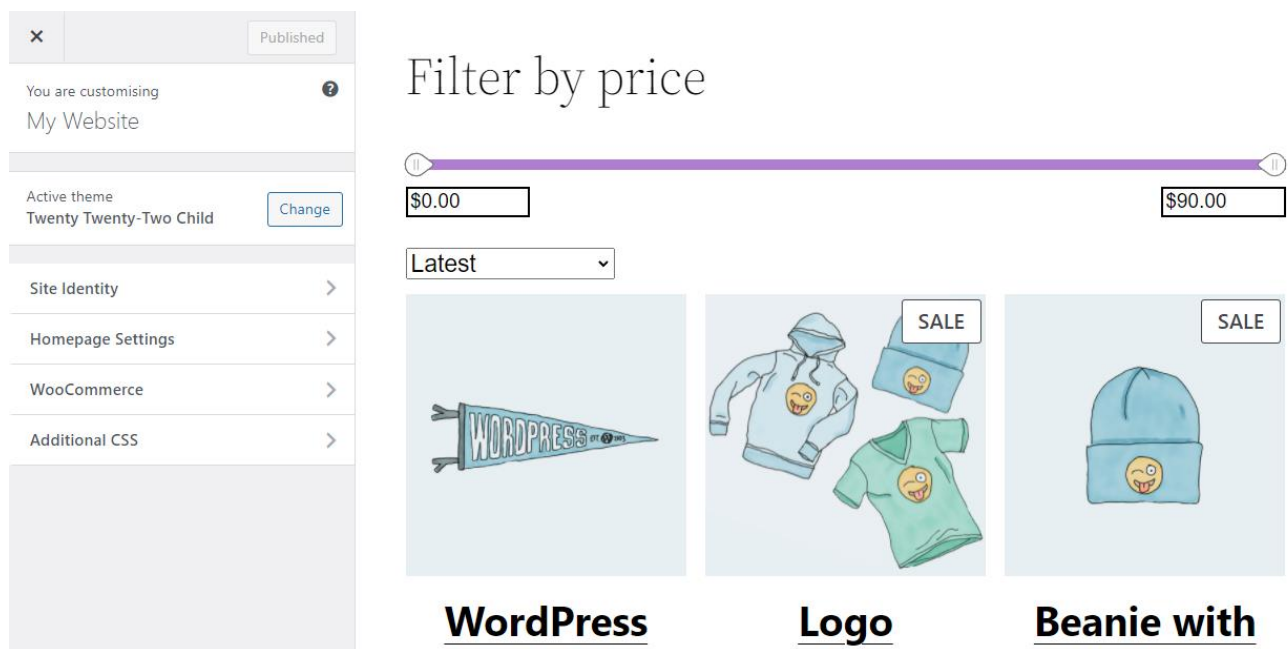
Visitors will be able to access the privacy policy that you set from both the login and registration screens. You can also add links to the page elsewhere.

How to use the WordPress customizer

The customizer is a tool within the WordPress dashboard that you can use to edit some of your website's basic settings (but not its style).

To access the customizer, go to **Appearance** → **Customize** in the admin. A new page will open, with a menu to the left and a preview of your site to the right.

The menu to the left includes your site's title and shows which theme you're using. You can use this menu to change or preview active themes without leaving the customizer.



Opening the **Site Identity** tab will enable you to update your site's title and tagline.

×

Published

<

Customising
Site Identity

Site Title

My Website

Tagline

Just another WordPress site

Site Icon

Site Icons are what you see in browser tabs, bookmark bars, and within the WordPress mobile apps. Upload one here!

Site Icons should be square and at least 512 × 512 pixels.

Select site icon

Filter by price

\$0.00

\$90.00

Latest



WordPress Pennant



Logo Collection



Beanie with Logo

The **Homepage Settings** tab gives you the option of changing your site's homepage. From this screen, you can choose whether to use a static homepage or to display your latest posts.

×

Published

<

Customising
Homepage Settings

You can choose what's displayed on the homepage of your site. It can be posts in reverse chronological order (classic blog), or a fixed/static page. To set a static homepage, you first need to create two Pages. One will become the homepage, and the other will be where your posts are displayed.

Your homepage displays

☐ Your latest posts

☒ A static page

Homepage

Shop

[Add New Page](#)

Posts page

– Select –

[Add New Page](#)

Filter by price

\$0.00

\$90.00

Latest



WordPress Pennant

\$11.05

Buy on the WordPress swag store!



Logo Collection

\$18.00 — \$45.00

View products



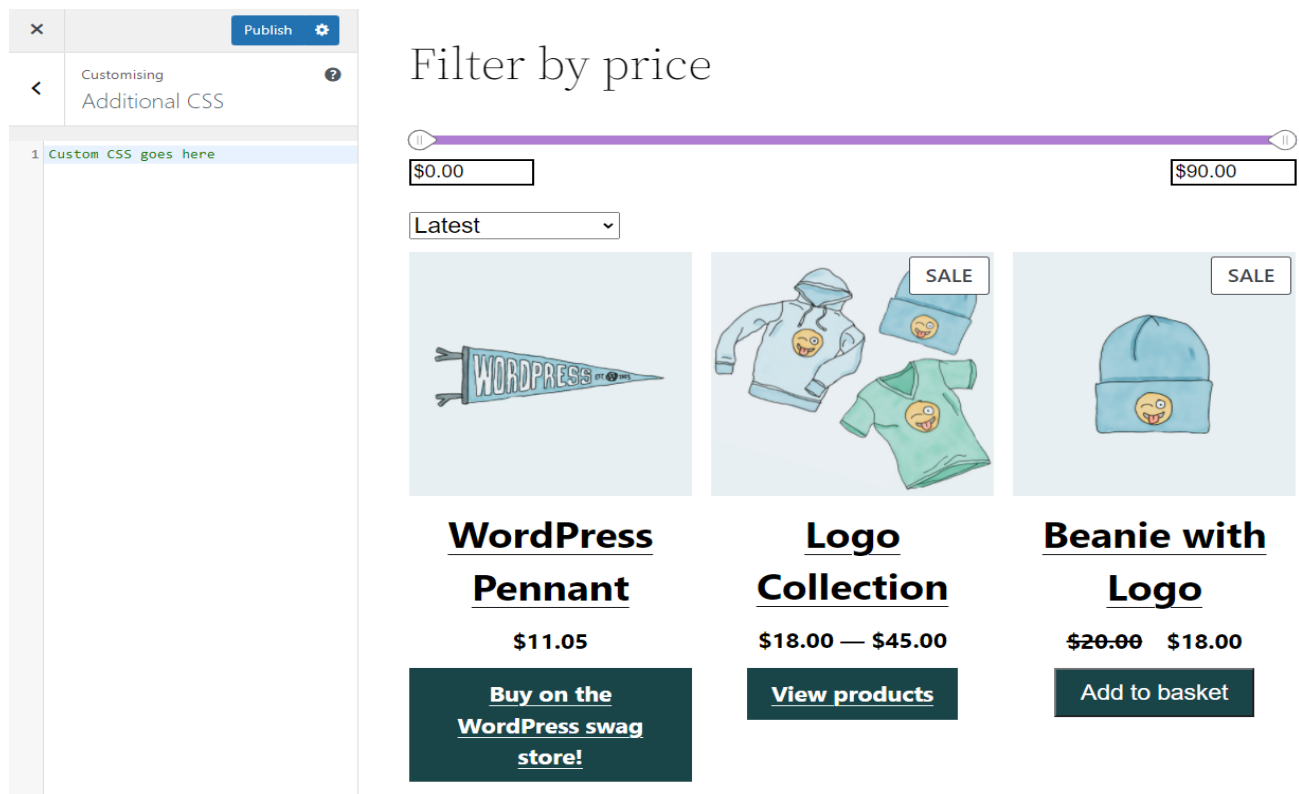
Beanie with Logo

~~\$20.00~~ \$18.00

Add to basket

Some plugins will cause additional tabs to appear in the customizer menu, like WooCommerce. What options you see in those tabs will depend on which plugins you're using.

The customizer also includes an **Additional CSS** tab. You can use the editor within that tab to add custom CSS to your website.



This is just one of several ways to add custom CSS to WordPress. Note that if you add CSS through the customizer, the code will apply to the entire website.

WordPress admin dashboard frequently asked questions

If you still have any questions left about the WordPress admin, this section will answer them. Let's start by talking about reorganizing menu items.

Can you reorganize your WP admin panels?

If you're comfortable editing WordPress core files, you can remove items from the main admin menu. It's also possible to rearrange or hide WordPress admin menu entries.

An easier approach is to use a plugin. The [Admin Menu Editor](#) plugin gives you full control over every menu entry in the dashboard. With this plugin, you can change menu titles and URLs, re-organize entries, hide links, and more.

Can you change the appearance of the WP admin interface?

There's a collection of plugins that enables you to change the style of the WP admin. These plugins are called "admin themes" or "dashboard themes." Installing a dashboard theme won't impact the WordPress admin's functionality.

To find admin themes, we recommend checking out the official WordPress plugin repository. A quick search for "[admin themes](#)" will reveal a large number of plugins. Keep in mind that admin themes don't affect the style of the front end at all.

Can you add a dark mode to your WP admin interface?

Yes, you can add a dark mode to the WP admin by using a dashboard theme plugin. One great option is [WP Dark Mode](#).

Can you disable the WP admin toolbar?

When you browse your site's front end while logged in, WordPress displays an admin toolbar at the top of the screen. You can disable that toolbar for specific users by going to the **Users** page in the admin and editing a specific account.

In that account's settings, look for the option that says **Show toolbar when viewing site**, and disable it. Save the changes to the user settings and repeat the process for other accounts.